

North Olmsted holds off North Ridgeville



TERRY MAHL/CHRONICLE

POSITION IS EVERYTHING: North Ridgeville's Jason Daniels (32) is higher but North Olmsted's Joe Smith (40) has the advantage as he goes up for a defensive rebound during his team's victory over the Rangers.

Oberlin's first half almost not enough

Robb Stolberg
The Chronicle-Telegram

OBERLIN — The Indians were sweating bullets at the end of Friday's boys basketball season opener against Rocky River — and it wasn't just from 32 minutes of fast-paced basketball.

The Pirates battled back from a 24-point halftime deficit to get within nine in the last three minutes of the game. But Oberlin's early lead stood up for a 72-62 win.

The Indians won the opening tip and scored first, which set the pace for the first half. They got out to a 22-2 lead by scoring 18 unanswered points. "We looked like a deer staring into headlights in the first half," said Rocky River coach Jim Rucki.

The speedy and scrappy Oberlin team had no trouble getting past Rocky River's man-to-man defense. "We ran them off the floor the first half," said Oberlin coach Joe Harris. "They were out of gas."

Oberlin led 25-6 after the first quarter and were still in control

Rocky Riv					Oberlin				
G	F	T	G	F	T	G	F	T	G
Cathey	2	4	10	Tilly	2	0	6	6	6
Standing	1	1	4	Chambers	3	3	9	9	9
Moran	1	1	3	Earl	0	0	0	0	0
Kennedy	3	0	6	Lake	2	6	10	10	10
Ferguson	2	0	0	Barbra	1	21	21	21	21
Dolan	0	0	0	Thomas	7	7	17	17	17
Nilesa	6	7	19	Gilze	4	1	9	9	9
Lchko	0	0	0	Nelson	0	0	0	0	0
Peate	0	0	2	Houglund	0	0	0	0	0
Keek	1	5	12						
Totals	21	15	62	Totals	28	17	72	72	72
Points by Quarters					Points by Quarters				
1 2 3 4 T					1 2 3 4 T				
Oberlin					Oberlin				
25 24 6 18 — 72					25 24 6 18 — 72				
Rocky River					Rocky River				
6 19 12 25 — 62					6 19 12 25 — 62				
Three-point goals					Three-point goals				
Rocky River: Chris Catley 2, Matt Ferguson 2, Chad Standring, Oberlin: DeQuan Thomas 3, Jacob Tilly 2					Rocky River: Chris Catley 2, Matt Ferguson 2, Chad Standring, Oberlin: DeQuan Thomas 3, Jacob Tilly 2				
Junior Varsity: Rocky River 62-34					Junior Varsity: Rocky River 62-34				

In the second although the Pirate offense started to warm up.

Antonio Barbra and DeQuan Thomas brought the Oberlin fans to their feet — and silenced the Pirates — with a pair of big dunks in the first half.

Oberlin's biggest boost was the dominance on the boards at both ends of the court. The Indians grabbed 41 rebounds on the night — 14 offensive and 27 defensive.

Barbra was the top rebounder with 20 on the night while Parren Lake had 10 defensive boards and 12 total.

Jacob Tilly hit two three-pointers in the last four minutes of the half to help put the Indians up 49-25 midway through the game.

But the team that came out of the locker room after halftime didn't look like the one that had gone in. It didn't force turnovers or move the ball around as it had in the first half. And it wasn't as dominant on the boards.

"Overall, I was only half happy," said Harris. "We only played half a ballgame."

Rocky River put together a 13-7 run to open the fourth quarter, but couldn't get much closer as the game turned into a foul-fest with the two teams trading points for the remainder of the game.

"They relaxed in the second half. We didn't have that killer instinct. That's what we need to develop," said Harris. He has a week to begin instilling that instinct in his team, when the Indians travel to Lorain Catholic.

Barbra led the Indians in scoring, with 21 points. Thomas buried three from outside the circle on his way to 17 points.

Olmsted Falls stops Brookside

Olmsted Falls.....78
Brookside68

SHEFFIELD — Nick Neumeister had 24 points, and Tim Schaefer and Matt Tabar added 19 apiece, as Olmsted Falls beat Brookside in a non-conference season opener for both teams Friday night.

Jon Wright scored 22 to lead

Brookside					Olmsted Falls				
G	F	T	G	F	T	G	F	T	G
Storey	0	4	4	Wright	8	5	22	22	22
Matts	3	2	8	Williams	3	0	6	6	6
Tabar	5	5	19	Mahon	5	0	12	12	12
Slipack	1	0	2	Schmitt	0	2	2	2	2
Neumeister	12	0	24	Racz	1	0	2	2	2
Schaefer	7	5	19	Rosso	3	2	8	8	8
			Ness	7	2	16	16	16	16
Totals	28	17	78	Totals	28	10	68	68	68
Points by Quarters					Points by Quarters				
1 2 3 4 T					1 2 3 4 T				
Olmsted Falls					Olmsted Falls				
21 14 24 19 — 78					21 14 24 19 — 78				
Brookside					Brookside				
13 19 16 20 — 68					13 19 16 20 — 68				
Three-point goals					Three-point goals				
OF, Tabar 3, Brookside, Mahon 2					OF, Tabar 3, Brookside, Mahon 2				
Junior Varsity: Olmsted Falls won					Junior Varsity: Olmsted Falls won				

Eagles cash in at the free throw line

Jim Jablonski
The Chronicle-Telegram

NORTH RIDGEVILLE — Strange things can happen on a basketball court during an opener. Sometimes winners come off the floor sounding like losers and vice versa.

The North Olmsted Eagles held on to defeat a stubborn North Ridgeville team, 54-49, but winning coach Tim Schmotzer wasn't thrilled with the game.

"Dr. James Naismith wouldn't have been too proud of what happened tonight," Schmotzer said. "It wasn't pretty basketball out there."

On the other hand, coach Dan Rademaker was fairly happy with his Rangers' play. "We're disappointed with the outcome, of course, but the effort was there. The kids really played hard," Rademaker said.

The Eagles seemed on the verge of opening up the game late in the third period as a 20-10 run, keyed by a pair of seven point bursts by Adam Gallagher and Joe Smith, gave them a 43-31 lead entering the fourth quarter.

N. Olmsted					N. Ridge.				
G	F	T	G	F	T	G	F	T	G
Tolbert	3	5	11	McNamara	3	0	8	8	8
Baredo	1	0	2	Baker	6	4	17	17	17
Belozer	3	3	11	Sgro	1	0	0	0	0
Gallagher	2	3	7	Daniels	0	0	0	0	0
Smith	7	3	17	Kudownia	0	0	0	0	0
Naffental	0	0	0	Cheon	3	2	9	9	9
Lozada	1	0	3	Jackson	6	1	13	13	13
Sulzer	0	0	0	Line	0	0	0	0	0
Beck	1	1	3	Vannoli	0	0	0	0	0
Totals	15	15	67	Totals	15	7	49	49	49
Points by Quarters					Points by Quarters				
1 2 3 4 T					1 2 3 4 T				
N. Olmsted					N. Olmsted				
10 11 22 11 — 54					10 11 22 11 — 54				
N. Ridgeville					N. Ridgeville				
9 8 14 18 — 49					9 8 14 18 — 49				
Three-point goals					Three-point goals				
N. Olmsted: Keith Belozer 2, Adam Gallagher, Joe Smith					N. Ridgeville: Dan McNamara 2, David Baker, Neil Cheon				
Junior Varsity: N. Olmsted, 38-33					Junior Varsity: N. Olmsted, 38-33				

North Ridgeville used the break between periods to good advantage, however. Junior Kevin Jackson came out hot, driving the lanes and baseline for a quick seven points that helped pull the Rangers to three down at 47-44 with 3:19 remaining.

It wasn't quite enough. Still trailing, the Rangers were forced to foul and Eltwan Tolbert made three free throws and Keith Belozer sank two to give North Olmsted the win.

"In the first half we were getting the ball inside," Schmotzer remembered. "But in the fourth quarter things got hectic, we got

excited and quit going to that. We started heaving up threes and they (the Rangers) got back into it."

Rademaker explained his team's first period in much the same way. The Rangers took a quick 7-0 lead and held the Eagles scoreless until 4:28 remained. "We jumped out to a lead and then got excited. We became impatient and didn't take good shots."

The Eagles' Keith Belozer hit a quick pair of threes that helped push his team to a 10-9 lead after one period. Then the North Olmsted inside game began to connect in the second as Eltwan Tolbert began to break the Ranger 2-3 zone before dishing off for easy baskets.

Three Eagles scored in double figures with Smith scoring 17 while Tolbert and Belozer each added 11. David Baker matched Smith's 17 for the Rangers and Jackson chipped in with 13.

Both teams are back in play tonight with the Rangers at Amherst and the Eagles at Strongsville.

No bad start this time

Avon looks sharp at L.Catholic

Scott Petrak
Chronicle-Telegram

LORAIN — December must be here. Malls stay open later and boys' high school basketball has begun.

Although just the first of many games, the inaugural contest can be used as a measuring stick and a springboard for the rest of the season. Avon used defense and rebounding to beat host Lorain Catholic 55-44 in both teams' opener.

Avon's coach Dave Kudela was thrilled to get the opening win, especially after starting the past three seasons 0-6, 1-9 and 0-9.

"To us (the first game) is really important," he said. "In the past we haven't started off real well. That first game's a big one for us."

Junior Josh Guerrieri led the Eagles' scoring with 14 points, but Avon's defense and rebounding were the deciding factors.

Avon					Lorain Catholic				
G	F	T	G	F	T	G	F	T	G
Guerrieri	4	4	14	Smith	5	1	14	14	14
Vega	5	1	11	Brown	3	0	7	7	7
Snaveley	4	2	11	Rose	2	3	7	7	7
Hayden	3	1	6	Francis	1	2	5	5	5
Benson	2	1	5	Gonzalez	2	0	3	3	3
Jones	2	0	4	Dickens	1	0	3	3	3
Crawley	1	2	4	Gedling	1	0	2	2	2
			Crawley	0	0	0	0	0	0
Totals	21	15	65	Totals	17	6	44	44	44
Points by Quarters					Points by Quarters				
1 2 3 4 T					1 2 3 4 T				
Avon					Avon				
12 18 14 11 — 55					12 18 14 11 — 55				
Lorain Catholic					Lorain Catholic				
13 11 12 8 — 44					13 11 12 8 — 44				
Three-point goals					Three-point goals				
Avon: Guerrieri 2, Snaveley					Lorain Catholic: Francis, Brown, Smith, Dickens				
JV Lorain Catholic 41-27					JV Lorain Catholic 41-27				

Avon collected 35 boards to the Spartans' 28. Junior Jeff Benson and senior Doug Hayden each had ten rebounds, many of which were offensive.

"We wanted to control the boards and try to get some second shots and try not to let them get some second shots," Kudela said. "Overall, we did an excellent job on the boards."

Lorain Catholic jumped to an early 9-2 lead, as both teams showed rust with turnovers and missed layups. Avon battled back to trail by one at the end of the first quarter, 13-12.

After Lorain Catholic's Jim Francis stole the inbound pass and hit a 3-pointer to start the second eight minutes, Avon made the run that turned the game in

their favor.

Guerrieri scored and was fouled to complete a 3-point play. Sophomore point guard Steve Vega then hit a jumper in the lane to give the Eagles their first lead, 17-16. The 5'5" guard was a spark plug all night, finishing with 11 points and a few no-look passes.

The Spartans took their last lead of the game at 18-17, before Junior Nick Snaveley hit a 3 for Avon.

"We really have a young team," Spartan coach Jim Lawhead said. "Our inside people are new and inexperienced. They just hurt us inside."

Avon stretched their lead to 10 at the start of the final quarter, but the Spartans would not go away. They pulled within six at 40-30, but were unable to hit a key shot to pull even closer.

"We just didn't execute at the time that when we had to and it slipped away from us, Lawhead said. "These are a scrappy bunch of young kids and it's a long season."

Both teams are young, with only three seniors on each roster. The Spartans schedule stays tough with a game at Amherst on Tuesday. Avon looks to go 2-0 as they host Lutheran West on Tuesday.

Keystone rolls in opener

Matt Pawlikowski
The Chronicle-Telegram

BROOKLYN — Keystone head coach Greg Morgan had no idea how his young team would perform entering Friday night's contest against Brooklyn, but was aware that it would take some senior leadership to dictate the outcome.

Gone with diplomas from last season, were a majority of his letterwinners.

It's a little early to make season predictions, but if the 'Cats 70-62 boys basketball win over Brooklyn is any indication of things to come, Keystone just might be a darkhorse in the Lorain County Conference race.

"This is a great way to start the season," said Morgan. "I'd have to give the team an A+ for effort, considering the inexperience we have. Our seniors showed some great poise out there. We've had only two weeks of practice, and to come in here, fight back and take home a win the way we did, you've got to be happy."

Keystone					Brooklyn				
	G	F	T		G	F	T		
Styles	0	0	0	Petro	4	3	11		
Knapp	3	1	9	Brown	5	0	13		
Sooy	2	0	4	Pattin	0	1	1		
Johnson	3	7	13	Ortiz	5	2	18		
Klinec	1	3	11	Antal	1	0	2		
Radway	6	1	13	Dubbar	7	0	7	18	
Beckham	5	2	12	Hiberg	2	0	4		
Accavare	0	0	0	March	0	0	0		
				Kohler	0	0	0		
Totals	23	14	76	Totals	18	9	62		
	Points by Quarters				1	2	3	4	
Keystone					14	13	23	— 70	
					29				
Brooklyn					14	16	15	— 62	
Three-point goals: Dubbar, Smith, Krupp;Knapp, Westlake, Klinec, 4, Brown, 3, Myer									